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OPERATION MIDWAY BLITZ

15 Illinoisans file claims against feds

Group alleges misconduct by agents during the large sweeps through the area last year

By **Caroline Kubzansky**
CHICAGO TRIBUNE

Juan Muñoz is tired of remembering the events of Oct. 3, 2025.

On that day, at the height of Operation Midway Blitz, Muñoz was among hundreds of people protesting the blitz at the Broadview processing center when dozens of agents confronted the crowd

outside the building and began to make arrests.

Muñoz, a trustee of west suburban Oak Park, appeared on video footage being pushed to the ground. He was handcuffed and held for about eight hours.

A year after Midway Blitz launched in Chicago, Muñoz has joined a group of 15 Illinois residents filing claims against the

federal government over agents' alleged misconduct during the massive sweeps through the city and suburbs last year.

"I had the right to stand there peacefully," he said. "I swore to uphold the Constitution and that day I watched people who had taken the same oath violate the very rights the Constitution guarantees."

Besides Muñoz, the claimants include an Evanston attorney who was detained while filming a federal arrest on Halloween and a man whose arrest outside Broadview

was later used in government social media posts. They're the latest U.S. citizens to turn to civil remedies in the wake of federal immigration enforcement across the country.

While there have been instances where state prosecutors have sought criminal charges against federal agents accused of misconduct during the raids, most notably in Hennepin County, Minnesota, following Operation Metro Surge, similar actions have so far been few and far between in Illinois.

One ICE agent, Adam Saracco,

pleaded guilty to misdemeanor battery over throwing a local lawyer and activist to the ground while filming him off-duty earlier this year. And while Illinois State Police have launched an investigation into the shooting death of Mexican immigrant Silverio-Villgas Gonzalez at the hands of immigration agents, Gov. JB Pritzker said Tuesday that probe would be "near impossible" to complete without additional cooperation from the

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JOHN J. KIM/CHICAGO TRIBUNE

City's Latino population shifts west

A new University of Illinois Chicago study finds neither Little Village nor Pilsen are home to Chicago's largest Latino population. That distinction now belongs to Belmont Cragin on the Northwest Side. Above, a woman walks past an apparel store decorated with flags from Latin American countries in the 5900 block of West Fullerton Avenue in Belmont Cragin on Thursday. **Chicagoland, Page A5**

3 weeks after spill, aging pipeline back in service

Cleanup continues; some fear only matter of time before it happens again

By **Adriana Pérez**
CHICAGO TRIBUNE

Almost three weeks after at least 1.3 million gallons of hazardous natural gas liquids spilled from an aging oil pipeline in northern Wisconsin, grinding service to a halt, fossil fuels once again began gushing through it last weekend.

But cleanup in the area continues, and members of the Bad River Band of Chippewa Indians — whose reservation the pipeline cuts across — warn that it's just a matter of time before it happens again, there or somewhere else, with even more catastrophic consequences.

In late July, the Michigan Supreme Court reversed the state's approval of a proposed tunnel to replace part of the pipeline, known as Line 5, that crosses the Straits of Mackinac, requesting additional environmental review.

In light of the decision, and pointing to years of back-and-forth litigation and a history of spills, Michigan Gov. Gretchen Whitmer last week urged the oil company, Canada-based Enbridge, to find alterna-

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Weiss Memorial Hospital sits along the 4600 block of North Marine Drive on Aug. 20 in Chicago. The hospital was closed in August 2025 by Resilience Healthcare. **STACEY WESCOTT/TRIBUNE**

Hospital owners reach an agreement

West Suburban, Weiss could ultimately be sold to Insight Health

By **Lisa Schencker**
CHICAGO TRIBUNE

After months of fighting in court, the owners of West Suburban and Weiss Memorial hospitals hammered out an agreement late Wednesday night that could ultimately see the hospitals sold to Insight Health Systems.

The agreement caps months

of battles in court between the two former business partners over who should control the now-shuttered safety net hospitals. It wasn't immediately clear what the deal will mean for any potential reopening of the hospitals, which both owners have said all along was their goal.

Under the agreement, the owner of Ramco Healthcare Holdings, Reddy Rathnaker Patlola, is buying out his business partner Dr. Manoj Prasad, who is the majority owner of Resilience Healthcare, which

has been operating the hospitals. Ramco owns the hospital properties, and Patlola has also been a minority owner of Resilience.

Ultimately, the hospitals would be sold to Insight.

Prasad and his attorneys did not immediately respond to a request for comment Thursday.

But Patlola said in a statement Thursday that Ramco "expects that the settlement will lead to a completed sale of Weiss Memorial Hospi-

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More red seats at play for midterms

Angst in GOP grows as polls tilt toward Democrats in races

By **Reid J. Epstein**
and **Shane Goldmacher**
THE NEW YORK TIMES

WASHINGTON — In Georgia, Republican strategists are privately discussing whether the Senate race has drifted beyond the party's reach.

In Kansas, Vice President JD Vance campaigned for a Senate Republican, even though a Democrat there has not been elected to the chamber since 1932.

In Nebraska, a new Republican super PAC just sprang up to spend to defend a billionaire incumbent.

And across the country, President Donald Trump's political operation is suddenly investing in what once appeared to be bright-red Senate races and House districts, including several in Texas that his party claimed to have safely gerrymandered only a year ago.

Less than seven weeks before the midterm elections, the political environment has deteriorated so badly for Republicans that the battlefield now extends deep into states and districts Trump carried three times, often by double digits.

"We have never felt better," Sen. Chuck Schumer of New York, the chamber's top Democrat, said in an interview, though he cautioned, "It's not an easy map."

Trump's diminished standing, as well as voter anger about high prices brought on by tariffs and the war with Iran, are causing serious problems for Republicans across the map.

And economic trends appear to be going the wrong way for the party.

The Federal Reserve raised interest rates Wednesday, which will drive up the cost of borrowing at a time many voters are already paying high rates for mortgages, auto loans and credit card debts.

Trump has said not to expect gas price relief before the midterms, with the nation's strategic petroleum reserves at a 44-year low.

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INSIDE

Moore standing at top of the class



How a studious approach, shaped by his parents, helped make Notre Dame's Leonard Moore the country's top defensive back. **Sports**

Customs and Border agent found guilty

Luis Uribe was convicted Thursday of raping and robbing sex workers in Chicago-area hotel rooms. **Chicagoland, Page A3**

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